
WORKING PAPER 1 · BEING

ORGANIZATIONAL SENTIENCE

How to recognize sentience — and what separates stage 4 from stage 5.

WHOEVER HAS MAPPED EVERYTHING.

Tóth-Pócs uses the **Coverage Ratio** ρ to measure how completely a system *believes* it has mapped its own possibility space. Three states: $\rho \rightarrow 1$ means **cognitive closure** — the system holds the space to be fully mapped. $0 < \rho < 1$ is stable. $\rho \rightarrow 0$ means **cognitive collapse**.

Health lies strictly between the extremes. A system that holds its space to be fully mapped is not mature — it is closed.

"Learning is expensive; forgetting is cheap."

Tóth-Pócs, G.: HORISMOS — Self-representation and the derived constitutional boundary in enriched cognitive systems. Conference poster, 19th Conference on Artificial General Intelligence (AGI-26), San Francisco State University, 27–30 July 2026. Poster documented first-hand; proceedings entry pending.

NOT AN ADD-ON. A COMPONENT.

The originators of the **Common Model of Cognition** treat metacognition as a **component of the architecture** — not as a by-product of capability.

That is a decision against the obvious assumption that a sufficiently capable system brings self-report along by itself. It does not. **It has to be built.**

For organizations: more data, more layers, more dashboards do not produce self-perception. They produce more reflexes.

Laird, J., Lebiere, C., Rosenbloom, P. & Stocco, A. (2026): Unified, comprehensive metacognition within the Common Model of Cognition. AGI 2026, Part II, LNCS 16855, pp. 1–15. Springer.

THREE ROUTES, ONE MEASURE.



Three contributions at the conference work on making a self-model measurable: Bergmann via a proxy metric, Salvi and Wolfson via machine correlates, Samsonovich and Khabarov via a multi-agent model.

The common move: **no one tries to measure consciousness directly.** Everyone measures whether a system holds a model of itself — and whether that model changes its behavior.

Not whether a firm feels. But whether it holds a model of its own state.

Bergmann (LNCS 16854, pp. 79–95) · Salvi & Wolfson (LNCS 16855, pp. 237–255) · Samsonovich & Khabarov (LNCS 16855, pp. 256–276). AGI 2026. Springer.

ARRIVED. AND NOTICED NOTHING.

You drive forty minutes of motorway: hold your distance, change lanes, respond to a brake light three cars ahead. As you get out, you cannot say what the route was like.

Nothing about this is a mistake. The drive was safe, the responses correct, the destination reached. What is missing is **access to your own state during the drive.**

Many good companies drive that way.

ELEVEN YEARS OF THE SAME REPORTING.

The figures are clean, the meeting takes ninety minutes, deviations are explained and remedied. Then customers no longer buy machines, they buy **uptime**.

The reporting does not notice — because it counts machines. Eighteen months later, sales says it clearly for the first time.

The figures are not wrong. What is wrong is **what is counted**. And the category was on no agenda. ρ was close to 1.

FOUR STAGES.

01

Blind — the organization does not notice the deviation

02

A person corrects — it notices, and a person remedies it

03

A routine corrects — it notices, and a procedure remedies it

04

It notices that its **way of noticing** has gone stale

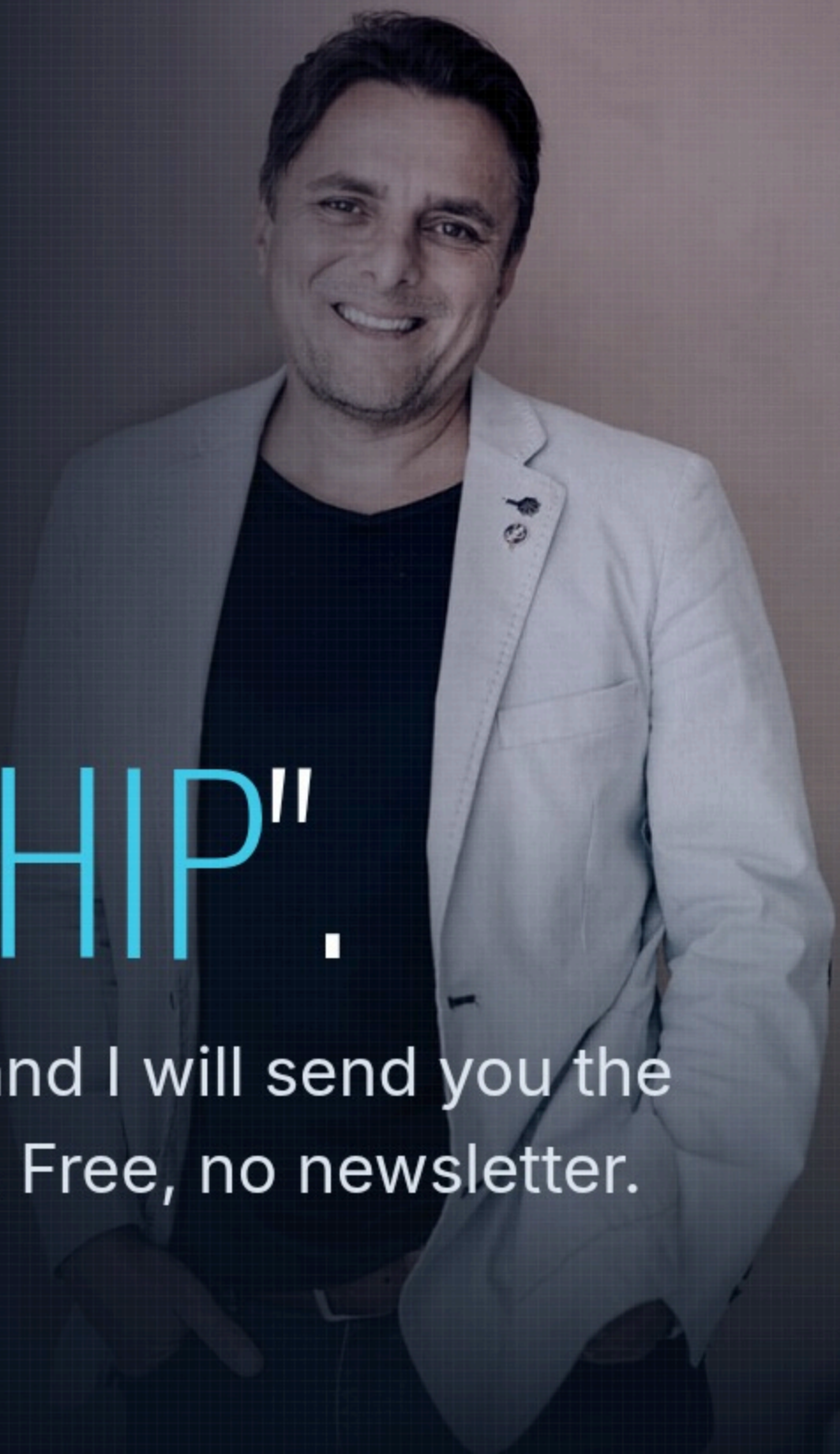
The jump from 3 to 4 is what this series is about — and the only one not reached by greater effort. The test to run first: "Does your organization lose its capacity for judgment when a central leader departs?" Cheap to run, hard to pass.

JUDGMENT AS A LOAN.

An organization can correct its state only as far as it can **register and report it**. Capacity for judgment bound to a person is not a property of the organization but a **loan**.

In LEAD21, five of the six properties have a named instrument — contact with reality in the Laser Meeting, self-perception in the Leadership Climate, regulation in Chamber 8, mission continuity in The Strategy, memory in Chamber 7.

Openness has none. The system brings problems quickly to the right place. It does not ask whether the places are still the **right** ones.



NEXT

SEND ME "LEADERSHIP".

as a direct message — and I will send you the working paper as a PDF. Free, no newsletter.

DO THIS TOMORROW

Ask: does our organization lose its capacity for judgment when a central leader departs?

Gerald Huesch — developer of LEAD21, the Leadership OS. Has trained over 30,000 leaders in 30+ countries, including NASA and Rolls-Royce.

All eight papers: gerald-huesch.com/press-en